MONTHLY UPDATE

National statistics: monthly update, September – October 2026

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> *27 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ANGOLA · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · CAMEROON · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · CONGO · DR CONGO · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ESWATINI · GABON · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Angola

The statistics institute put a revision of the statistics law and a draft national strategy for the development of statistics to public consultation from 29 September to 2 October, following an extraordinary plenary of the national statistics council in August. Neither draft text is held.

Botswana

One absence in that system was dated this month. No gambling participation statistics are held as the country moves to lower the legal betting age, while an investigation reports unregistered betting influencers drawing 4,000 to 15,000 responses to a single betting slip and directing followers to bookmakers through referral links. The activity is documented and the population is not counted, which is the gap a statistical strategy would have to close.

Burkina Faso

The statistics institute announced a national statistical innovation observatory at the statistics council's session of 11 September, using satellite imagery, mobile-phone, web and weather data and artificial intelligence to produce indicators for all 351 communes within days. The same session reviewed a draft 2027 statistical programme costed at CFA 10.6 billion, 52.7% of it state-financed. No timetable for the observatory and no data-access agreement with mobile operators is stated.

Cameroon

Counting for the fourth population and agriculture census closed on 15 September 2026, the date set by the prime minister's July order, after a start on 24 April and two extensions. Coverage is stated to have stayed below expectation; no final rate or date for results is published.

Central African Republic

The statistics institute posted the regulator's first-half 2026 market observatory on 16 September, compiled from the returns operators must file under the regulator's decision of 25 June 2025. It puts internet clients at more than 23% of the population.

The institute held the mid-term evaluation of the second national statistics strategy in Bangui on 7 to 9 October 2026, financed by UNDP; the strategy is to be updated with revised indicators and a realigned calendar.

Chad

The statistics institute set out what it publishes and on what terms: five channels, from an Open Data Portal to a development-plan indicator tracker, against an archive policy barring transmission of microdata without prior written agreement. The pipes are built and the licence is what is missing.

Congo

The statistics institute held a workshop to set up a permanent statistical system for informal cross-border trade, with a baseline survey planned for 2027.

DR Congo

The central census bureau's technical coordinator said on 1 September that the cartography phase of the second general population census is under way with digital tools and satellite imagery. No enumeration date is published. Census cartography was launched on 28 September, the operation costed at USD 192 million with general enumeration from July 2027; ministers said the census counts residents and identifies no one.

Equatorial Guinea

The statistics institute went out to the ministries rather than waiting for their returns. A ministry-by-ministry supervision tour of statistical services began on 2 September at the interior and education ministries and runs to 9 September, ordered by the national statistics council's eighth session of 27 August, to assess each service's state and consolidate the national statistical system. No findings, service inventory or report from the tour is published, and the account is the institute's own.

On 25 September INEGE presented the ninth national statistical yearbook, covering the last five years, naming weak administrative registers, undigitised processes and poor interoperability between information systems among its outstanding challenges. It restated the plan for the fifth population census and the first agricultural census without giving dates.

Eswatini

The inclusion survey is in the field: the 2026 FinScope round covers 3,200 households in 320 enumeration areas, the first measurement since the 2018 round put inclusion at 87%, with no publication date given.

Gabon

On 18 September the Council of Ministers adopted three statistics decrees, amending the statistics institute's statutes and reorganising the National Statistics Council and the Special Fund for Statistics, the last to secure financing and reduce dependence on external funds.

The energy ministry is building a national energy information system to produce energy balances and SDG 7 indicators, fed by the 2026 census. No start date or first balance is stated.

Ghana

The statistical service and Statistics Denmark agreed the design of a third three-year phase of their cooperation, centred on integrating administrative data held by ministries and agencies; no start date or funding figure is stated.

Guinea

The planning minister launched the country's first general census of enterprises on 16 September, with two months of field collection in the Kindia pilot region. No national schedule, method or budget has been published.

Kenya

The communications regulator and the University of Nairobi began reviewing preliminary findings from a joint national survey on child online protection and safety on 9 September 2026, with the report structure and thematic areas agreed ahead of validation and the findings intended as the evidence base for regulatory interventions. Neither the sample size nor the fieldwork period is held. The social development directorate drafted a second Inclusive Data Charter action plan for 2026 to 2030, widening the first plan's disability focus to gender, children and older persons.

Lesotho

Census enumeration is complete, with mop-up operations still running in Maseru on 17 September 2026; it is the first census to ask questions recognising gender identity and sexuality. A second phase of the mapping of financial access points was tendered in September, to update the 2018 baseline across the ten districts.

Libya

The information authority met the information centres of the prime minister's office and several ministries in Tripoli on 14 September to agree how they supply indicators to a Unified Directory for National Indicators, and set the order for completing it. The directory is not yet published. A green industry centre published a report of industrial and environmental indicators recording 305 registered industrial establishments, 301 of them private, and 26,034 workers.

Mali

The Council of Ministers took note on 9 October 2026 of the fourth Schéma Directeur de la Statistique and its action plan for 2026 to 2030, on a written communication from the economy and finance minister. It sets four axes: management of the national statistical system, its capacity, statistical production, and analysis with modernised dissemination and use. The text is not held.

Mauritius

The central bank opened its own statistics rather than waiting for the statutory framework to be rewritten. It launched a central statistical database on 3 September, developed with the International Monetary Fund and the African Development Bank, opening statistical information to businesses, researchers, policymakers and citizens;

the prime minister said a standards and codes report had underscored the need to strengthen statistical capacity and modernise dissemination, and that the statistics statute and the central bank statute are being reviewed. No series list, update cadence, licence or machine-readable access route is stated for the portal.

Mozambique

A journalism school announced a Media Barometer on 4 September 2026, a permanent mechanism to track audience trust in the media, disinformation and deepfakes.

Nigeria

The agriculture ministry said on 29 September it had finalised a Federal Department of Agricultural Data and Analytics to coordinate a single standard for a national farmers register. No establishing instrument is held.

Rwanda

The higher education council said it is building a national performance measurement framework to capture, digitise and publish standardised data on students, staff, research and graduate outcomes, having lacked comparable data across institutions. No publication date is set.

The same announcement records that Kigali hosts the UN regional hub for big data and data science, run with the statistics institute and two UN bodies to help African statistical offices use new data sources; no output figure is stated.

Senegal

An outside assessment put the statistical system at two speeds. An International Monetary Fund report found macroeconomic statistics generally reliable while sector-specific statistical agencies are constrained by staffing and finance, and recommended a clearer coordination mandate for the statistics agency through a permanent inter-agency committee reconciling national accounts, public finance, debt, monetary and external-sector figures before publication, alongside broader public-debt reporting and steps toward the enhanced dissemination standard. The authorities accepted the recommendations under the 2024-2028 statistical strategy; nothing dated is published against any of them.

Sierra Leone

The census has a date and a hole in its budget. The president set Census Night for 1 December 2026 and put the financing gap at US$37m, against US$24m committed by government of which about US$15m is disbursed. The civil registration authority put a draft 2025 vital statistics report to two days of stakeholder validation.

The census technical committee received the national mapping completion report on 15 September, closing cartographic work for the country's first digital census ahead of Census Night on 1 December 2026. The statistics agency deployed the technology for the digital census, with enumeration by tablet set for 2 to 16 December 2026.

South Africa

An expression of interest for a consultant to develop South Africa's National Strategy for the Development of Statistics was issued on 9 September 2026, under a regional statistics project run through the SADC secretariat. A deputy minister in the Presidency said in a keynote address on 9 October 2026 that Census 2031 is in development, and called statistical independence a constitutional safeguard.

Togo

The statistics institute's third harmonised household living-conditions survey runs to December 2026, covering poverty, income and employment.

Tunisia

The National Statistics Council reviewed the statistics institute's development strategy and its 2027 work programme at its second ordinary plenary of the year on 16 September, alongside its own annual statistical programme and the progress of the general agricultural census. Neither the strategy nor the work programme is published with the communique. The regulator's survey breaks internet use down by age, income, sex and district: 99.2 per cent at 18 to 24 against 54.1 per cent at 60 to 70, and 69.1 per cent in the poorest households against 95.9 per cent in the richest.

Uganda

The bureau went to cultural institutions for the administrative records the civil register does not capture, signing memoranda with the Samia Bugwe and Tieng Adhola institutions on collecting, managing and sharing community-generated information, births and deaths particularly, with the bureau providing technical support and training. Its own argument for it is the interesting part: better administrative records would strengthen the population register and reduce what a national census costs. Neither text is held and no coverage or start date is published.

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